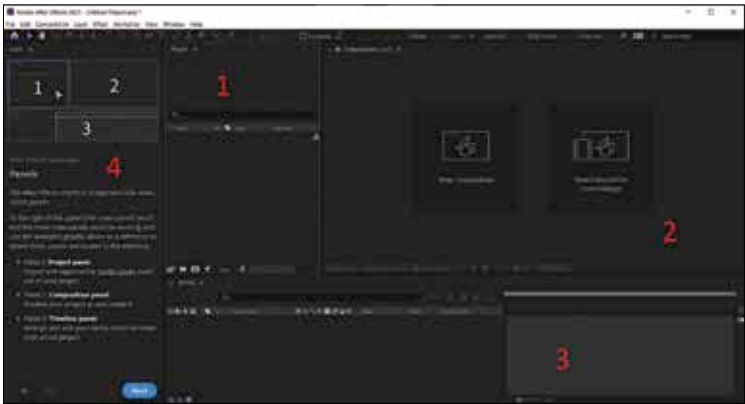


Upon starting the tutorial, we are taken to the After Effects project, into the thick of things.

Since the inception of After Effects in 1992, the User Interface hasn't really changed all that much give n the time frame but a lot of continual improvement has been made, making things easier, more streamlined and uber-efficient.

The UI is divided into panels (each panel is a specific pre-designated area on the application) to separate different aspects of the application to make it easier for the user to navigate AE. There are primarily 3 different panels:



1. Project Panel, 2. Composition Panel, 3. Timeline Panel, (4) Learning Panel

- 1) Project Panel – This is the space where we will import and organise all of our media assets for the project.
- 2) Composition Panel – This panel is used to preview the project as we create and proceed with it.
- 3) Timeline Panel – This is where we actually work with our media assets, arranging and editing them to create a perfect piece of art.
- 4) Learning Panel – This is not a panel that is ever present but it is something will guide and assist us during this initial awkward phase where we get to know After Effects better and until we get reasonably acquainted with it.

These panels are really quite handy as it's pretty flexible and one can easily resize the panel by just bringing it to the border and resizing it once the cursor turns into the resize cursor. The tutorial recommends playing around with the panels before moving on to the tutorials.